

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8  
 ♥ K Q J 9 6 3  
 ♦ T 4  
 ♣ 7 6 3

♠ A K Q 6

♥ 7 4 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ K 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 9 4 3

♥ 5

♦ 8 6 5 2

♣ J T 9 4

♠ 7 5 2

♥ A T 8

♦ A 9 3

♣ A Q 8 2

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♣   |
| 2 ♥          | Dbl   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 6NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6NT by South |       |      |       |
| ♠s.          |       |      |       |

East now holds the the only guard in ♠s.

Play the ♦ A, then ♦ K Q.

East will follow to all three ♦ s.

Now for the squeeze. Play dummy's ♦ J and discard your ♥ 10.

If East discards the ♠ J you will cash dummy's ♠ 6, then win the last 3 ♣ tricks.

So East will no doubt throw a ♣ instead. In which case you win the last 4 ♣ tricks.

Squeezes are so very satisfying.

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♥ K.

As usual, you have 11 winners; 3 ♠s, 1 ♥, 4 ♦s and 3 ♣s. If ♠s split 3-3 dummy's ♠ 6 will become trick #12. If ♠s don't split though, you will have the chance of a squeeze if the defender with long ♠s also has 4 or more ♣s.

For a squeeze to operate you will need to lose one trick and the time to do that is right now. Let West hold the ♥ K and win his ♥ continuation with your ♥ A.

East discarded a ♦ on the second ♥.

You might as well find out about the ♠s right now. Play the ♠ A K Q.

Too bad, West discards a ♥ on the third round of

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K T 7 3  
 ♥ K Q T 6  
 ♦ 3 2  
 ♣ T 9 5

♠ Q 5 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ K Q 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ T

♣ J 8 6 3

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4

|          |       |      |       |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
| West     | North | East | South |
|          |       |      | 1♦    |
| Pass     | 2NT   | Pass | 4♦    |
| Pass     | 5♦    | Pass | 6♦    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6♦ by South

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from dummy on the third ♦.

[showcards N:SQ,HA,H8 E:SJ,S9,H9 S:HJ,H7,D7 W:SK,HQ,HT]

West could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

But when you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

South is to play 6♦. West leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that West must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

**Board 3**  
East Deals  
None Vul

♠ 6 5 4 2  
♥ J  
♦ 9 8 4 3  
♣ J T 9 3

♠ A K J  
♥ K 7 3  
♦ A 6 5 2  
♣ 8 6 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q T 9 3  
♥ T 5 4  
♦ K J T  
♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7  
♥ A Q 9 8 6 2  
♦ Q 7  
♣ 7 5 2

|             |       |      |       |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| West        | North | East | South |
|             |       | 1NT  | 2♥    |
| Pass        | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by South |       |      |       |

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♣J. East wins  
♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

East takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

East opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and West has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with East and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

You plan to squeeze East by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to East.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. East is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

[showcards N:SA,SK,SJ,D6 E:SQ,ST,S9,DK S:S8,S7,H6,DQ W:S6,S5,D9,D8]

East is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

East can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not East.

If you discard the ♦6 East will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, East will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ K Q T 6 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ T 8 6 2

♦ J T 7 3

♣ -

♠ Q 7

♥ A 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ A J 9 7 3 2

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1 ♣   |
| Pass     | 2 ♦   | Pass | 3 ♣   |
| Pass     | 4 ♣   | Pass | 4 ♥   |
| Pass     | 4 ♠   | Pass | 6 ♣   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6 ♣ by South

Unblocking the ♠ A to create a Threat out of your ♠ Q is the Vienna Coup.

As you see, East was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣ 7 and discard dummy's ♠ 2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠ K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠ Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6 ♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥ K.

South is to play 6 ♣. West leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠ K and that a squeeze will be possible.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you should rectify the count, so you win the first trick, pull trumps in two rounds, then give up a ♥ trick.

West takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦ 9 which you win with your ♦ Q.

You now make the key play of taking dummy's ♠ A before running three rounds of ♣ s.

[showcards N:S2,DA,DK,D8 E:SK,DJ,DT,D7 S:SQ,D5,D4,C7 W:SJ,ST,HQ,D2]